

FELIX GONZALEZ | Systems Engineer

Master in Cybersecurity and Postgraduate Degree in IT Management

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Extract

Team influencing and problem-solving skills, a passion for staying technically current, ability to become an expert in new technologies, and strong vision for increasing adoption of planned and future solutions.

Experience

Director of IT Infrastructure and Cybersecurity

Sep 2019 - Present

Celistics Servicios y Logistica USA, LLC / Movilway LLC. Sunrise, Florida – US

Job Overview

Establish and execute strategic, comprehensive enterprise information security program directives and plans, including all region-wide information security training efforts to ensure the organization's overall cybersecurity and infrastructure including hardware, software, servers, databases, storage solutions and networking in support of critical business needs.

Key Functions/Responsibilities

- Lead and guide on information security topics, advising and collaborating on security processes, business continuity and disaster recovery plans, ensuring the IT infrastructure design for current and future business needs around cybersecurity, networks, data centers and cloud standards.
- Design the infrastructure and security enterprise architecture On-premises and Cloud.
- Coordinate the Internal Incident Response Team (IRT) on Identifying and preventing Cybersecurity Incidents
- Create and maintain the Corporate Cybersecurity Framework based on NIST CSF and CIS Controls
- Lead the hardening process align with CIS Benchmarks
- Create, manage and coordinate internal Phishing campaigns to test user awareness (Cybersecurity Awareness Training Program)
- Coordinate with the external SOC (Security Operation Center) and the IRT to convey security incident information and react to contain/mitigate cyber threats.
- Coordinate and manage Vulnerability assessments and Patch Management process for Devices, Workstations and Servers.
- Coordinate and lead Exposure Management and Continuous Security validations
- Develop and maintain the Corporate Disaster Recovery Framework including DR and Cloud Backup following the 3, 2, 1 strategy.
- Develop, manage and track the Corporate Infrastructure and Cybersecurity annual budget
- Research, evaluate and recommend new Infrastructure/IaaS/SaaS and Cybersecurity technologies to support business requirements.
- Design, monitor and maintain data center environments, networks and servers to ensure security and availability.
- Lead Internal and External Infrastructure Penetration Testings, Web Application Penetration Testings.
- Act as internal consultant to stakeholders about security, network scoping, solutions implementation, and support.
- Provide direction, guidance, and training to IT staff

Certifications

Cloud Certifications

- Azure Administrator
Current: 2023 - 2024

Storage Certifications

- Dell EMC Compellent Storage Center
Advanced Administrator

Physical Server Certifications

- Dell PowerEdge Blade Server
Solutions (13G)

Servers, Client, Network, and Best Practices

Microsoft Most Valuable Professional – MVP: Virtualization

- MCITP | Enterprise Administrator
- MCITP | Server Administrator
- MCITP | Desktop Enterprise Administrator 7
- MCITP | Virtualization Administrator
- MCSA 2012 | Server Infrastructure
- MCSA 2008 | Windows Server
- Microsoft Forefront Client and Server
- MCT | Microsoft Certified Trainer
(current:2023-2024)
- ITIL v3 Foundation

Microsoft Certified Professional
Transcript (Credentials Validator)

<https://mcp.microsoft.com/authenticate/validate/mcp.aspx>

Transcript ID: 791912
Access Code: 1C3A0656

Skills and experience

Microsoft Servers Family

- SharePoint Server 2013-2016
- Lync Server/Skype for Business Server
- Exchange 2013-2019
- Right Management Services
- Hyper-V Server 2008/R2/2016/2022
- System Center Virtual Machine Manager 2008/2012 R2/2016
- System Center Essentials 2007/2010

Goals achieved as Director of Technology | Infrastructure and Security

- Have created the corporate cybersecurity and Disaster recovery model based on NIST Cybersecurity Framework.
- The implementation of the Cybersecurity Stack:
 - Cisco Secure Endpoint as EDR Solution
 - Cisco Umbrella and as Secure Web Gateway
 - Cisco SecureX as XDR solution with automated playbooks (using APIs for closing silos between security vendors in the security stack and gaining visibility and response)
 - SentinelOne as XDR solution because of the transition/migration of Cisco Secure Endpoint
 - Secureworks Taegis XDR with Identity Detection and Response (IDR)
 - AlienVault USM Anywhere as SIEM/SOAR Solution integrated with Cisco AMP, Cisco Umbrella, OTX and VirusTotal
 - AT&T Open Threat Exchange (OTX) for Threat Intel
 - Zscaler Internet access because of Cisco Umbrella migration project
 - Cloudflare as Web Application Firewall (WAF) solution
 - Microsoft Defender Attack Surface Management (ASM)
 - Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps as Cloud Access Security Broker (CASB) solution
 - Microsoft Defender for Office 365 as SaaS security solution
 - Cymulate for Continuous security stack validations automating Pentesting simulations
 - Acronis Cyber Protect for Microsoft 365 backup strategy (Teams, SharePoint and OneDrive).
 - ManageEngine EndPoint Central as Deployment, Asset, Vulnerability and Patch Management process solution.
 - Watchguard AuthPoint and Microsoft Azure as Multifactor Authentication solution.
 - Microsoft Azure Application Proxy as Web Application security control
 - Microsoft Azure Password Protection to detect and block known weak passwords and their variants in AD On-Premises and in Azure AD/Entra ID.
 - SOC services with AT&T Cybersecurity
 - SOC/MXDR/Threat Hunting Elite with Secureworks
 - 3,2,1 Backup strategy including cloud backup with Veeam
 - Shodan for continuous Attack Surface Monitoring
- Microsoft Security
 - Entra ID AD Hybrid Join/Entra ID Joined
 - Entra ID Conditional Access
 - Microsoft Defender for Identity
 - Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection
 - Microsoft Intune
 - Azure Site Recovery as a DR Site solution for Business-Critical Applications
- The design and implementation of the Cybersecurity program based on:
 - Vulnerability Management
 - Patch Management
 - Incident Response Plan
 - Breach and Attack Simulation including ATP and Cyber Kill Chain
 - Cybersecurity Awareness Training
 - Offensive Exercises (Gray box and Black box Pentesting):
 - Infrastructure and Applications (Web and Mobile)
 - Cybersecurity Governance

Virtualization Platforms

- Microsoft Hyper-V 2008/2012-R2/2016/2022
- VMware ESX/ESXi v5-v6-v7
- vCenter v7

Microsoft OS

Clients:

- Windows 7
- Windows 8
- Windows 10
- Windows 11
- Servers:
- Windows Server 2008/R2
- Windows Server 2012/R2
- Windows Server 2016
- Windows Server 2019
- Windows Server 2022

Others:

- Desktop Optimization Pack for Software Assurance (MDOP)
- 2016/2017/2018

Cloud Computing: IaaS and SaaS

IaaS

- Microsoft Azure (Storage, Compute, Networking, Azure Active Directory)
- Hybrid Cloud Ecosystems
- AWS Cloud Storage

SaaS

- Office 365
- Microsoft 365
- EOP
- ProofPoint
- Cloudflare

Disaster Recovery Planning (DRP)

- Solutions architecture: Enterprise-scale and SMB disaster recovery with Microsoft Azure
- Veeam Availability for Always-On Enterprise (Veeam Backup & Replication)
- Veritas Backup exec

Monitoring Solutions

- Solarwinds
- Veeam One (Backup Infrastructure)
- Zabbix
- PRTG
- LogicMonitor (Cloud)

Converged Infrastructures and Modular Solutions

- DELL VRTX
- DELL FX2
- DELL M1000
- DELL Power Edge Servers
- DELL Storage Systems (PowerStore, SC Compellent, MD PowerVault and PS Equallogic)

- Zero Trust Implementations
 - **Microsoft** Global Secure Access // Secure Service Edge (SSE)
 - Entra ID Private Access and Entra ID Internet Access
 - Cloudflare Zero Trust
 - Cloudflare Tunnel
- Datacenter Hardware Refreshment Project including Power, Compute, Networking and Storage into a world-class Converge **Infrastructure** solution achieving financial efficiencies for the Organization.
- Lead the implementation of the WIFI **architecture** with Ubiquiti transitioning/migrating from Cisco Meraki
- Lead the implementation of the monitoring system with PRTG
- Adoption of **Microsoft** 365
- Adoption of Hybrid **Infrastructure** & Identity with **Microsoft Azure**
- Lead the implementation of ProofPoint Essentials
- Lead the change from ProofPoint to ProofPoint Enterprise including the integration with SentinelOne.
- Lead the LUMU NDR design and implementation with SentinelOne, Cisco Umbrella, Zscaler ZIA and Firewalls (Watchguard and Fortigate) integrations.

Head of IT Operations LATAM

Jun 2019 – Oct 2019

Millicom Internationals Services LLC – TIGO

Corporate responsible for planning, developing, implementing and evaluate the IT Operations framework and IT **governance** to secure quality and availability of operational processes, services and the performance of business-critical systems in LATAM operations.

Director of Technology | CTO

Jun 2018 – Jun 2019

Celistics Servicios y Logística USA LLC. Aventura, Florida – US

Job Overview

Direct reporting to the General Manager. Lead a multidisciplinary team in more than 10 countries ensuring the optimization and continuous improvement of Technology processes aligned with the business.

Key Functions/Responsibilities

- Oversee IT operations and supervise systems and IT staff
- Develop strategy as it relates to the organization's IT **infrastructure** (computer and information systems, **security**, Telecommunications)
- Develop, manage and track the IT department's annual budget
- Identify technology needs and make recommendations to business decision-makers
- Evaluate the company's adherence to federal technology requirements for **security**
- Manage the IT team including developers, **security** analysts, support technicians and vendors
- Maintain company hardware and **software** programs
- Update technological equipment company-wide
- Implement company-wide technology updates and hold sessions to teach employees on new features
- Consult senior-level stakeholders across the entire organization to identify business and technology needs and to optimize the use of information technology

Security:

Frameworks & Standards

- NIST CSF
- MITRE AT&CK
- **Cyber** Kill Chain
- CIS Controls
- COBIT
- GDPR (EU)
- LGPD (Brazil)

Firewalls

- Fortigate
- Watchguard XTM Series
- CheckPoint

SIEM

- AlienVault USMA

Threat **Intelligence**

- VirusTotal
- Cisco Talos
- OTX (Open Threat Exchange) | AT&T **Cybersecurity**

Assets Vulnerability & Patch **Management**

- Shodan
- NESSUS
- ManageEngine Vulnerability **Management**
- ManageEngine EndPoint Central
- ManageEngine Patch **Management**

Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and XDR

- Sophos (Certified)
- Trend Micro
- Cisco Secure EndPoint (AMP)
- SentinelOne
- Bitdefender

Secure Email Gateways

- ProofPoint
- Avanan (CheckPoint: Harmony Email & Collaboration)

WAF & **DNS** Protection

- Cisco Umbrella
- Cloudflare
- Zscaler ZIA

Security Validation Solutions - Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)

- Cymulate

Corporate Core Infrastructure Manager

January 2014 – June 2018

Celistics Servicios y Logística USA LLC. Aventura, Florida – US

Job Overview

Direct reporting to the CIO. Lead the IT Infrastructure team (Data Center, Telecommunications, Products, and Helpdesk) collaborating with stakeholders and business partners to plan and execute complex On-premises Infrastructure projects based on Private Cloud and Hybrid Cloud solutions including Microsoft Azure services (Azure Active Directory, IaaS, Backup Strategies and Site Recovery).

Key Functions/Responsibilities

- Design and Implement Disaster Recovery with focus on Virtualization.
- Asset management, Storage (plan, implement and maintain).
- Monitor and manage physical and virtual servers.
- Design and implement networking policies region-wide (LATAM & Spain).
- Implementing/complying with Information Security policies.
- Lead DELL Enterprise Storage projects region-wide (LATAM & Spain).
- Planning and identifying opportunities for cost savings, service quality improvement and vendor management.
- Develop, implementing, testing, and maintaining disaster recovery plans (DRP).
- Responsible for Infrastructure procurement
- Evaluate, and recommend technologies to support business requirements.
- Create and maintain documentation for all processes and procedures.
- Monitor and maintain datacenter environments, networks, and servers to ensure security and availability.
- Track project plan & actual expenses against budget.
- Team management by assigning projects and tasks.
- Recruiting and training new Infrastructure Team employees.
- Prepare and submit periodic project status and availability reports to the CIO.

Goals achieved as Infrastructure Manager

- Design, plan and implementation of the Enterprise Helpdesk System (ServiceDesk Plus by ManageEngine).
- Design, plan and implementation of the Enterprise Monitoring System (SolarWinds: Network Performance Monitor, Server Application Monitor, IP Address Manager, Virtualization Manager, Storage Resource Monitor)
- Implementation of SharePoint 2013 as the enterprise Intranet and LMS Portal.
- Plan the implementation of Microsoft Skype for Business 2015 (Migration Project from Microsoft Lync) as part of the Unified Communications Strategy with AVAYA Platform and Mediant AudioCodes.
- Plan the implementation of Microsoft Exchange 2013 as the enterprise email System (UM enabled).
- Design, plan and implementation of the Virtual Infrastructure migration path from Rackmountable Servers to DELL M1000 Blade System, DELL FX2, DELL EMC Equallogic and DELL EMC Compellent Storage based on Microsoft Hyper-V as a Hypervisor achieving a 35:14 consolidation ratio using 10GbE world-class switching infrastructure force10 S-Series and DELL N Series.

External Attack Surface Monitoring & Management

- Microsoft Defender External Attack Surface Management

Application Proxy

- Azure AD Application Proxy

EndPoint Protection

- Microsoft Forefront (Certified)
- Microsoft Defender

Wireless

- Cisco Meraki Solutions
- Ubiquiti UniFi

Load Balancers

- Coyote Point (FortiADC)
- Barracuda BLB Series

- Implementation DR Plan based on: **Microsoft** Hyper-V Clusters (**Windows** Server 2012R2), vmware vSphere, System Center Virtual Machine Manager, Veeam **Backup** & Replication 9.5, Veritas **Backup** Exec 16 and LUN Storage replication (using DELL Equallogic) and **Azure** Site **Recovery**.
- Implementation of AzureAD for SSO between On-Premises **Active Directory** and **Azure** Certified Apps (third parties: DropBox Business, PeopleSoft, **Office** 365, PowerBI and ConnectWise).
- Implementation of Exchange Online Protection as email **security** gateway.

IT Infrastructure Manager

November 2010 - April 2012

Celistics Venezuela, Caracas – Venezuela

Key Functions/Responsibilities

- Plan, design and maintain IT Services and **Data** Center Products (Hosting, Physical and Virtual Colocation, E-Commerce and Wireless Internet Products) locally and remotely in the NAP of the Americas.
- Ensured the profitability of the **infrastructure** department.
- Ensured customer satisfaction.
- Defined the **methodology** to tackle **security** issues, **disaster recovery**, business continuity and service level agreements to be applied to clients and within the Datacenter in the Nap of the Americas.
- Ensured motivation of team members as well as their professional **development**.

Senior IT Technical Lead

March 2007 - October 2010

Cavallin Attias Sistemas (**Microsoft** Gold Partner), Caracas – Venezuela

Key Functions/Responsibilities

- Define, plan, audit, and implement technology policies.
- Responsible for the IT Outsourcing business unit.
- Coordinate, supervise and control IT projects: Technology Consulting and the implementation of **Microsoft** solutions in corporate environments.

Founder

February 2000 - March 2007

MacroWeb Solutions, Caracas – Venezuela

Key Functions/Responsibilities

- Business **Development** in IT outsourcing: Support, **Security**, Networking and Website Design
- Identifying business opportunities
- Create and maintain the overall marketing plan for the business
- Attend to clients and ensure customer satisfaction by introducing adjustments to products and services
- Carry out the HR function for the business
- Build strategic partnerships
- Lead all IT related projects

Information Technology Trainer

July 1998 - July 2001

Centro Integral de Atención Tecnológica CIAT, Caracas – Venezuela

Key Functions/Responsibilities

- Trainer for MS Office (Basic / Advanced), Communication protocols (TCP/IP) Windows NT Server, Windows 95/98, Internet programming languages (JAVA, HTML, ASP), Web Hosting (Internet Information Server - IIS)
- Repair and maintenance of PCs.

Education

Master's Degree, Cybersecurity

Universidad Católica de Murcia, Murcia – Spain

March 2021 – March 2022

Cybersecurity Certificate Program, Computer Forensics and Counterterrorism

FIU Florida International University

October 2020 – January 2021

Postgraduate Degree, Information Technology Management

Universidad Santa María, Caracas – Venezuela

October 2006 - October 2008

Bachelor's Degree, Systems Engineer

Universidad Santa María, Caracas – Venezuela

October 1999 - October 2005

Personal career path certification and education plan 2023-2026

Q2 2024- Q3 2024

- Microsoft Certified: Cybersecurity Architect
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert
- EC Council: Disaster Recovery Professional

Q4 2024 – Q2 2025

- ISACA Degree: Certified Information Security Manager (CISM)

2025 - 2026

- MBA Degree: MBA

Groups and Associations

ISACA: Florida Chapter

ACTIVITIES AND AWARDS

- Microsoft Most Valuable Professional Award 2009 - 2010 | 2010 - 2011
Expertise Area: Virtualization
- Microsoft TechNet-MSDN Community Lead (2009 - 2011)
Personal Technology Blog: <http://felixgonzalez.wordpress.com>
- Writer for Microsoft TechNet Flash newsletter and MSDN newsletter: Chapter LATAM (2009-2012)
- Expert Consultant for Microsoft MVA (Microsoft Virtual Academy for Latin America) – 2009

Management, Defender Attack Surface Management, Cynet Posture Management, Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (Security), Defender for Cloud Apps (CASB), MFA. ME Desktop Central, ME Vulnerability Management • 🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩: Fortinet, Watchguard, CheckPoint, Cisco ASA, Barracuda, Cloudflare, Meraki, Ubiquiti. • 🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩🚩: Servers Infrastructure, Virtualization, Cloud Infrastructure, Datacenter, Information Security, Cybersecurity Assessments (Posture, Vulnerability), Cloud Security including AWS and Azure, Disaster Recovery. My goal is to make the company I work for achieve its strategic objectives and vision from a perspective of modernization through technological transformation, observing the cybersecurity landscape as a pillar of the business continuity, while influencing and empowering the professional teams that supports me along the journey by allowing them to develop their skills.

Work History

Total Work Experience: 18 years

- **Director Of IT Infrastructure & Cybersecurity** Celistics USA LLC & Movilway LLC
Oct 01, 2019
- **Chief Technology Officer (CTO)/Director Of Technology** Celistics USA LLC & Movilway LLC
Jun 01, 2018
- **Corporate Infrastructure Manager** Celistics USA & Movilway LLC (Celistics Holdings)
Mar 01, 2007

Education

- **Masters** | Murcia Catholic University (UCAM)
- **Bachelors** | Universidad Santa Maria
- **Pre-Masters** | Universidad Santa Maria

Skills

- **decision making** - 20 years
- **leadership** - 20 years
- **microsoft technologies** - 20 years
- **policy development and administration** - 20 years
- **project management** - 20 years
- **relationship-building** - 20 years
- **disaster recovery** - 19 years
- **budget management** - 17 years
- **business-oriented** - 17 years
- **coaching** - 17 years
- **delegation** - 17 years
- **incident management** - 17 years
- **recruiting** - 17 years
- **risk management** - 17 years
- **strategic thinking** - 17 years
- **cisco asa** - 14 years
- **email** - 14 years
- **virtualization** - 14 years
- **active directory** - 13 years
- **antivirus** - 13 years
- **microsoft servers administration** - 13 years
- **microsoft windows** - 13 years
- **microsoft wsus** - 13 years
- **network management** - 13 years
- **network monitoring** - 13 years
- **network operations** - 13 years
- **enterprise networks** - 11 years
- **microsoft certified professional** - 11 years
- **data center administration** - 10 years
- **data centers** - 10 years
- **dell poweredge** - 10 years
- **hyper-v** - 10 years
- **infrastructure architecture** - 10 years
- **infrastructure manager** - 10 years
- **itil** - 10 years
- **itil management** - 10 years
- **load balancing** - 10 years
- **management information systems** - 10 years
- **management skills** - 10 years
- **microsoft scvmm** - 10 years
- **san** - 10 years
- **storage** - 10 years
- **storage architecture** - 10 years
- **storage management** - 10 years
- **storage virtualization** - 10 years

- **system center** - 10 years
- **virtual desktop** - 10 years
- **virtual machine manager** - 10 years
- **virtual machines** - 10 years
- **cloud** - 9 years
- **microsoft dpm** - 9 years
- **azure ad** - 8 years
- **it management** - 8 years
- **meraki** - 8 years
- **network design** - 8 years
- **security** - 8 years
- **dell equallogic** - 7 years
- **equallogic** - 7 years
- **fortinet** - 7 years
- **microsoft exchange** - 7 years
- **microsoft exchange administration** - 7 years
- **veritas** - 7 years
- **watchguard** - 7 years
- **acronis** - 5 years
- **acronis true image** - 5 years
- **azure** - 5 years
- **blade servers** - 5 years
- **microsoft office 365** - 5 years
- **solarwinds** - 5 years
- **veeam** - 5 years
- **acronis cyber protect** - 4 years
- **cloud architecture** - 4 years
- **cyber security** - 4 years
- **microsoft windows azure** - 4 years
- **dell compellent** - 3 years
- **microsoft sharepoint designer** - 3 years
- **proofpoint essentials** - 3 years
- **alienvault usma** - 2 years
- **microsoft defender for cloud apps** - 2 years
- **microsoft defender for office** - 2 years
- **shodan** - 2 years
- **lumu ndr** - 1 years
- **microsoft defender attack surface** - 1 years
- **proofpoint enterprise** - 1 years
- **sentinelone** - 1 years
- **zscaler zia** - 1 years
- **application**
- **application virtualization**
- **backup and restore**
- **biblioteca de**

- centro de datos
- **cloud** computing
- committees
- communication
- **cybersecurity**
- directorio activo
- expenses
- hyper v
- incident response
- infraestructura
- liderazgo de equipos
- **microsoft** cluster
- **microsoft** sql server
- network administration
- network **architecture**
- network **engineering**
- network **security**
- **office** 365
- presentations
- relationship **development**
- **security** awareness
- seguridad de red
- servidores
- storage area networks
- strategic planning
- team leadership
- telecommunications
- telecomunicaciones
- user provisioning
- vdi
- vmware
- vulnerability
- **windows**
- **windows** 7
- **windows** server
- wsus
- **business continuity** - 19 years
- **data** center - 16 years
- **controls** - 9 years
- **training** - 8 years
- **cto** - 5 years
- **sophos** - 4 years
- **technical training** - 7 years
- **consulting** - 11 years
- **it outsourcing** - 11 years

- web design - 7 years

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: Remote or On-Site or Hybrid
- Likely to Switch: False
- Willing to Relocate: True
- Travel Preference: 25%
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:
 - US Citizen
- Security Clearance: False
- Desired Hourly Rate: 110+ (USD)
- Desired Salary: 210,000+ (USD)
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time
 - Part-time
 - Contract - Corp-to-Corp
 - Contract - Independent
 - Contract to Hire - Independent

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/felixgonzalezc>
- twitter: <https://twitter.com/virtuallytech>
- Dice: <https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/021fdc6fefa7e3b9af5b79a55e2645e1>